

CRIME INVESTIGATION — EVIDENCE REPORT

Case Reference: MNG-2025-CR-0047

Forensic Team: Dr. Anitha Rao (Lead), Constable Mohan K.

Evidence Logged: 15 March 2025, 02:30 AM

1. Physical Evidence at Scene

Item E-001: A heavy iron rod (approximately 60 cm) recovered 4 metres from the victim. Bloodstains matching victim's blood group (O positive) were found on the rod. Partial fingerprints were lifted from the rod's handle end and sent for forensic analysis. Preliminary examination suggests the rod is the likely murder weapon based on wound patterns.

Item E-002: A torn piece of dark blue fabric, approximately 8x5 cm, was recovered near the warehouse entrance. Fibres appear consistent with a formal jacket or blazer. The fabric has been sent to the forensic lab for fibre-type analysis and potential DNA testing.

Item E-003: A crushed cigarette stub (brand: Classic Milds) found near the eastern wall of the warehouse. DNA saliva sample collected. The victim was a non-smoker.

Item E-004: A mobile phone (Samsung Galaxy A52) found 2 metres from the victim. Phone belongs to the victim. Last call received at 9:45 PM from an unregistered number. WhatsApp messages found showing a meeting request from an unknown contact saved as 'V.K.' at 8:30 PM that evening.

2. CCTV and Digital Evidence

CCTV Camera 1 (Petrol Station, Bunder Road): Captures Arjun Nair arriving on his motorcycle at 10:10 PM. A dark-coloured SUV (partial plate visible: KA-19) is seen parked 50 metres from the warehouse entrance from 9:58 PM onwards.

CCTV Camera 2 (Fish Market Entrance): Captures a male figure in a dark blue jacket entering the warehouse at 10:15 PM. The individual's face is not clearly visible. Height estimated between 5 feet 9 inches and 6 feet. Build: medium to heavy.

CCTV Camera 3 (Bunder Road Junction): Captures the same SUV (KA-19) exiting the area at 10:52 PM, approximately 2 minutes after the security guard placed the emergency call. Only one occupant visible in the vehicle.

Phone Records: Call logs from the victim's phone confirm a call from an unregistered SIM at 9:45 PM. Cell tower data places the caller within a 1.5 km radius of Bunder Road at the time of the call. The victim's office email shows threatening messages received on 1 March and 8 March 2025 from an anonymous sender.

3. Witness Statements

Witness 1 — Govinda Shetty (Security Guard, Bunder Fish Market): Heard loud arguing between at least two male voices at approximately 10:30 PM. Heard a loud crash shortly after. Could not identify the individuals. Confirmed seeing a dark SUV parked near the warehouse when he arrived for his shift at 10:00 PM.

Witness 2 — Kavitha Shenoy (Resident, nearby building): Saw a tall man in a dark blue jacket walking hurriedly away from the warehouse direction at around 10:50 PM. The man appeared agitated and was talking on a phone. Partial description: dark jacket, medium-heavy build, approximately 5 feet 10 inches tall.

Witness 3 — Dinesh Mallya (Auto Driver): Confirms dropping a passenger near the Bunder Road junction at 10:05 PM. The passenger was a male wearing a grey shirt, appeared calm, paid in cash, and did not engage in conversation. Description does not clearly match any known suspect but is noted for the record.

4. Financial Evidence

Audit documents recovered from the victim's laptop (office-issued) reveal a trail of transactions totalling Rs. 28 lakh routed through dummy vendor accounts. The transactions are linked to accounts controlled by individuals within Coastal Exports Pvt. Ltd. Several large cash withdrawals were made from the company's petty cash account in the two months preceding the incident. A personal loan of Rs. 5 lakh issued by the victim to a business associate remained unpaid. Financial records indicate disputes over repayment in the weeks before the murder.